Staff answers & diagnostic guide — Analysing curated spaces and audience impact

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 4 Part 2 · Big question: How do curatorial choices — scale, lighting angle, sightlines, and framing — shape audience meaning in an exhibition?

Starter answer & explanation

Question: Why is 'raking light' (light shone from a shallow side or top angle) essential when exhibiting textured collagraphs and structural reliefs?

Correct: Raking light catches the top ridges brightly while casting long, dark shadows across the recessed planes, revealing the full 3D depth — Exactly! Without directional light, physical relief loses half its visual power.

Guided team check (We do) answers

Q1: Once you test raking light from the top-left on your relief panel, how can you amplify that effect permanently with dry-brush patina? -> Skim bright chrome or white chalk along the top-left edges of the beams and deepen the bottom-right undercuts with charcoal/black (Yes! Locking directional highlights onto the light-facing flanges doubles the 3D illusion.)

Q2: What happens to audience attention if twenty relief panels are crammed edge-to-edge with zero wall gap between them?

-> Visual overload — the individual silhouettes blur together and the viewer cannot read each structure's frame (Correct. Generous wall spacing acts as a silent frame around each piece.)

Q3: What is the role of an exhibition 'interpretation panel' at the entrance of a studio showcase? -> To introduce the shared brief, explain the studio processes on display, and invite visitors to look closely at structure and surface (Spot on. Good interpretation bridges the maker's studio process and the visitor's eye.)

Exit check answer

Question: Why does 'raking light' (shone at a shallow angle across the surface) make a relief panel look far more dramatic than flat front lighting?

Correct: It catches the raised ridges brightly while casting crisp, elongated shadows across the recessed planes — Correct. Raking light maximizes tonal contrast across 3D textures.